

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a property magazine:



Co-living

Co-living is the latest trend to hit Hong Kong's property market. In a co-living building, tenants usually have their own bedroom but share the kitchen, bathrooms and living areas. It can be substantially cheaper than normal renting and has the added potential benefit of fostering a community spirit. We went to *Weave*, a co-living space in Prince Edward, to find out more about it.

The 13-storey *Weave* feels like a university hall of residence, but more grown-up.

The first two floors of the building are taken up by a restaurant. There is also a games area. On the third floor is the kitchen and living area, which includes a reading corner, a gym, some sofas and a TV – perfect for group movie nights. There are also vending machines around the room for late-night needs.

The rest of the floors have bedrooms, some shared and some private. Shared rooms are around 250 square feet and can sleep four people. They also have a bathroom. These rooms are the least expensive, at around HK\$7,200 per month. Standard rooms are for one person and have their own bathroom, but they are only around 100 square feet.

Finding somewhere to live in Hong Kong that is both comfortable and affordable is a real challenge, and not everyone can commit to a long-term contract. Co-living takes away this pressure, while also ensuring that you have a clean, safe, and well-maintained place to sleep, eat and relax.

Your class has been asked by your teacher to look at alternatives that young people have to living at home. Your group has been asked to discuss co-living. You may want to talk about:

- the advantages of co-living
- the disadvantages of co-living
- what rules you think co-living accommodation should have
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you enjoy co-living?
2. What would you find difficult about co-living?
3. Do you think that co-living will become popular?
4. Why is having some private space important?
5. What would your dream accommodation be?
6. Why do some people prefer to live by themselves?
7. What might you learn from co-living?
8. Should the government encourage co-living?